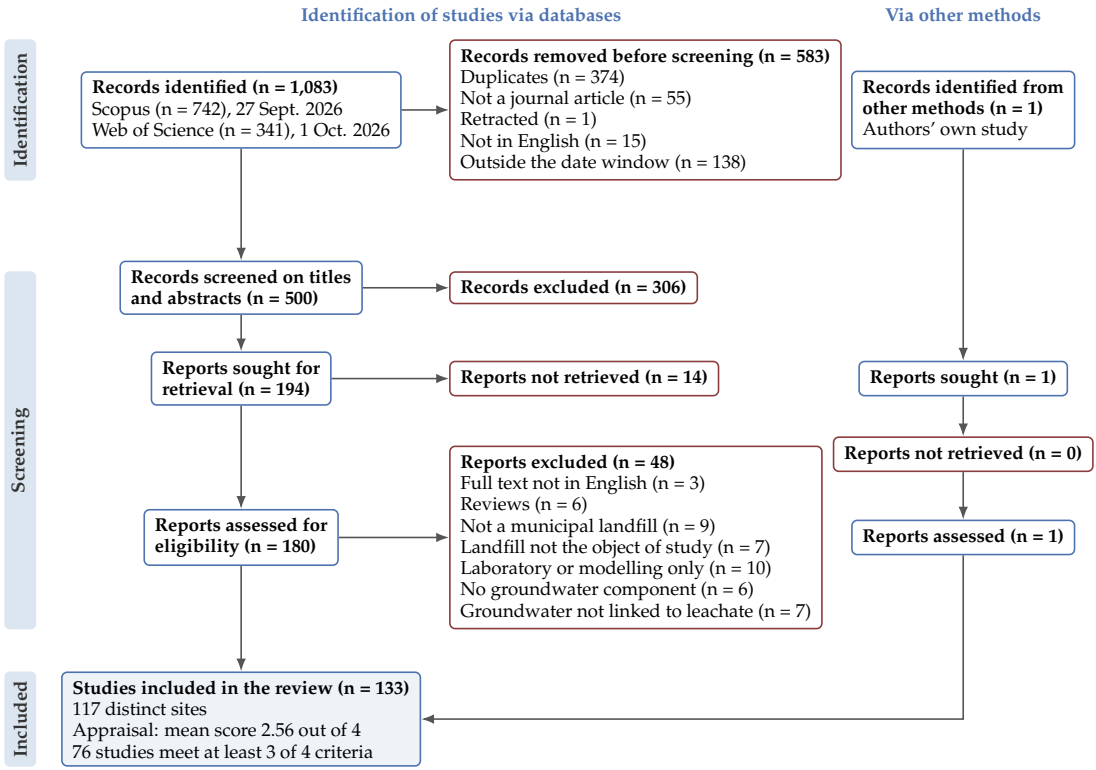
Identification of studies via databases
Via other methods
Identification
Screening
Included
Records identified (n = 1,083)
Scopus (n = 742), 27 Sept. 2026
Web of Science (n = 341), 1 Oct. 2026
Records removed before screening (n = 583)
Duplicates (n = 374)
Not a journal article (n = 55)
Retracted (n = 1)
Not in English (n = 15)
Outside the date window (n = 138)
Records identified from other methods (n = 1)
Authors' own study
Records screened on titles and abstracts (n = 500)
Records excluded (n = 306)
Reports sought for retrieval (n = 194)
Reports not retrieved (n = 14)
Reports sought (n = 1)
Reports not retrieved (n = 0)
Reports excluded (n = 48)
Full text not in English (n = 3)
Reviews (n = 6)
Not a municipal landfill (n = 9)
Landfill not the object of study (n = 7)
Laboratory or modelling only (n = 10)
No groundwater component (n = 6)
Groundwater not linked to leachate (n = 7)
Reports assessed for eligibility (n = 180)
Reports assessed (n = 1)
Studies included in the review (n = 133)
117 distinct sites
Appraisal: mean score 2.56 out of 4
76 studies meet at least 3 of 4 criteria